LEARN · GRAMMAR

A2

Past Simple



Use the past simple for actions and situations that are completely finished — usually with a time word like **yesterday**, **last week**, or **in 2019**.

ONLY ONE PAST-TENSE MARKER, EVER

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE / QUESTION
verb + -ed (or irregular)	**did / didn't + base verb**
She walked. · She went. (go → went)	*She didn't walk. · Did she go?*
irregular? no rule — just learn it	✗ **Did you called her?**
go → went · eat → ate · see → saw	✓ **Did you call her?**

✗ **I didn't went. · What she cooked?**

✓ **I didn't go. · What did she cook?**

the base verb never carries -ed once did/didn't is there — and a question word never replaces "did"

1 Spelling of regular -ed forms

Most verbs → -ed
walk → walked · play → played

Ends in -e → -d
live → lived · dance → danced

Consonant + y → -ied
study → studied · carry → carried

Short consonant-vowel-consonant → double
stop → stopped · plan → planned

2 Use

A finished action at a specific time, a sequence of finished past events, or a past habit or state that isn't true anymore.

- I **visited** my grandmother last weekend.
- He **woke up**, **got dressed**, and **left**.
- I **lived** in Rome for two years.

3 Questions with a question word

Put the question word before 'did': **What / Where / When / Why + did + subject + base verb?**

- **What did** she cook?
- **Where did** they travel last summer?
- **Why did** he leave the party early?

4 Common mistakes

✗ She goed to school.	✓ **She went to school.**	irregular verb
✗ Did you called her?	✓ **Did you call her?**	base verb after 'did', no -ed
✗ He studyed all night.	✓ **He studied all night.**	y → i before -ed

APPLY · PRACTICE

A2

Past Simple Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. Yesterday she ___ to the cinema. **(go / went / gone)**
2. ___ you see the match last night? **(Did / Do / Were)**
3. He ___ a letter to his friend. **(write / wrote / written)**
4. He ___ me back yesterday. **(didn't call / not called / doesn't call)**
5. They ___ tired after the long hike. **(was / were / is)**
6. They ___ a new house last spring. **(buy / bought / buys)**

B Complete with the verb in brackets

1. We ___ (eat) pizza for dinner last night.
2. She ___ (not / like) the film. She left early.
3. I ___ (wake up) late and ___ (miss) the bus.
4. The lesson ___ (start) at nine and ___ (finish) at ten.
5. She ___ (catch) a bad cold last week.
6. We ___ (not / have) enough time to finish the test.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. I buyed a new phone last week.

   _____

2. Did she went to the party?

   _____

3. She didn't studied for the exam.

   _____

4. Where did you went on holiday?

   _____

5. We was very happy at the party.

   _____

6. Did she forgot her passport at home?

   _____

D Make it negative, then a question

1. he / work / on Saturday

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

2. she / call / you last night

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

3. they / watch / the film on Sunday

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

4. we / visit / our grandparents last week

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Tell your partner what you did yesterday morning using past simple.
2. Ask your partner 'Did you...?' questions about last week.
3. Ask three 'Where did you...?' questions and answer them.